

Flock Safety & ALPR Misuse Master Database

39 verified incidents · Case IDs with FLK- prefix are Flock-attributed; ALPR- prefix = vendor unconfirmed as Flock

1. Case_ID: FLK-2026-001 | Year: 2026 | State: TX | Agency_Jurisdiction: Pasadena Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Sgt. Michael Palitz | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Co-worker Stalking / Harassment | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: An active internal investigation revealed Sgt. Palitz allegedly abused the Pasadena Police Department's Flock Safety license plate reader camera system to track and stalk a female fellow police officer. According to City Council Member Emmanuel Guerrero, the abuse involved such 'overwhelming use' that the automated system itself flagged the account and notified department administrators. Palitz resigned while under active investigation.
2. Case_ID: FLK-2026-002 | Year: 2026 | State: GA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Albany Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Tytianna Davis, Jade Jackson, Nicholas Richardson, Brittney Smith, Issac Whitus (5 Officers) | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Unauthorized Access / Personal Tracking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: An internal agency audit revealed that five officers repeatedly accessed the city's Flock Safety LPR camera system for personal, non-law enforcement purposes. The officers used automated plate tracking data to monitor individuals without legitimate investigative justification.
3. Case_ID: FLK-2026-003 | Year: 2026 | State: WI | Agency_Jurisdiction: Milwaukee Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Detective Tehrangi Chapman (Internal Affairs) | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking / GPS Tracking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: An Internal Affairs detective assigned to investigate another officer's ALPR stalking case used MPD's Flock camera network 20 times between Jan 2024 and Jan 2025 to stalk two individuals. He logged queries under false justifications like 'training' and 'test', and secretly installed an unauthorized GPS tracking device on one victim's vehicle.
4. Case_ID: FLK-2026-004 | Year: 2026 | State: GA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Cherokee County Sheriff's Office | Subject_Officer_Involved: Lt. Chris Bryant, Sgt. Mike Creeden, Deputy Cynthia Jodesty | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Unauthorized Access / Personal Tracking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: A self-initiated audit by the agency's Real-Time Intelligence Division uncovered anomalies in Flock search logs involving two supervisors and one deputy. Investigation confirmed all three used LPR cameras to track license plates for personal reasons unrelated to official police duties.
5. Case_ID: FLK-2026-005 | Year: 2026 | State: GA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Richmond County Sheriff's Office | Subject_Officer_Involved: Sheriff's Deputy (Unnamed in state report) | System_Vendor: Flock Safety / ALPR | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Personal Tracking / Unauthorized Search | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: A Richmond County deputy was arrested and charged after an audit revealed they had used the department's automated license plate recognition database for non-law enforcement personal tracking.
6. Case_ID: FLK-2026-006 | Year: 2026 | State: GA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Greene County Sheriff's Office | Subject_Officer_Involved: Deputy Quinsha Goss | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Personal Tracking / Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: A departmental audit found that Deputy Goss accessed Flock license plate readers to run searches involving at least one license plate for personal reasons over a 3-month period without any law enforcement mandate.
7. Case_ID: FLK-2026-007 | Year: 2026 | State: WI | Agency_Jurisdiction: Menasha Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Officer Cristian Morales | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Officer Morales utilized the city's Flock ALPR camera network to track an ex-girlfriend, running multiple unauthorized searches without legitimate investigative justification.
8. Case_ID: FLK-2026-008 | Year: 2026 | State: KS | Agency_Jurisdiction: Bonner Springs Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Detective Kyle Rector | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Detective Rector allegedly used automated license plate readers to track his estranged wife and two men he suspected were her new romantic partners without law enforcement authorization.
9. Case_ID: FLK-2026-009 | Year: 2026 | State: CA | Agency_Jurisdiction: San Francisco Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: SFPD Patrol Officer (Unnamed in report) | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Conflict of Interest / Unauthorized Search | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: An officer used SFPD's Flock ALPR system to locate his wife's stolen car for personal reasons, violating department rules regarding conflicts of interest. He then posted an image of the vehicle on social media.

10. Case_ID: FLK-2026-010 | Year: 2026 | State: MO | Agency_Jurisdiction: Joplin Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Patrol Officer (Unnamed in agency disclosure) | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Unauthorized Access / Excessive Tracking | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: An officer was discovered to have abused the department's Flock Safety database by conducting 395 unauthorized searches on a single license plate without any active investigative case.

11. Case_ID: FLK-2026-011 | Year: 2026 | State: FL | Agency_Jurisdiction: Monroe County Sheriff's Office | Subject_Officer_Involved: Sheriff's Deputy Lamar Roman | System_Vendor: Flock Safety / ALPR | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Stalking / Unlawful Traffic Stop | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Deputy Roman allegedly used an ALPR system to track and eventually pull over a woman he had met while providing off-duty security on a television set, monitoring her private vehicular movements.

12. Case_ID: FLK-2026-012 | Year: 2026 | State: IL | Agency_Jurisdiction: Prairie Grove & Holiday Hills Police Dept. | Subject_Officer_Involved: Officer / Chief William C. Copp | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Officer Copp, who simultaneously served as Police Chief of nearby Holiday Hills, abused authorized police access to search Flock ALPR databases for vehicle locations of several former romantic partners and at least one of their new partners.

13. Case_ID: FLK-2026-013 | Year: 2026 | State: CA | Agency_Jurisdiction: San Francisco PD & Los Altos PD | Subject_Officer_Involved: Municipal Operators & Federal Agencies | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Mass Surveillance / Illegal Data Sharing | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: A class action lawsuit revealed that federal immigration and law enforcement agencies accessed SFPD's Flock cameras over 1.6 million times, while Los Altos shared data over 1 million times with out-of-state agencies, violating California statutory privacy laws designed to protect civil liberties and immigrant communities.

14. Case_ID: FLK-2026-014 | Year: 2026 | State: CA | Agency_Jurisdiction: San Diego Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Detective Gary Gonzales / Patrol Officers | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Flawed AI Recognition / False Arrest | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: San Diego police relied on a false Flock hit to arrest Ariel Beltran and Parra at gunpoint inside a cigar lounge for an attempted carjacking 5 miles away. The camera hit occurred before the pursuit began, proving physical impossibility, yet police ignored cell phone location alibis and arrested both men.

15. Case_ID: FLK-2026-015 | Year: 2026 | State: MN | Agency_Jurisdiction: Plymouth Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Patrol Officers / Automated System | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Flawed AI Recognition / False Stop | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Automotive journalist Joel Feder and his wife were boxed in by four Plymouth PD squad cars outside a Kohl's after Flock ALPR alerts on a Range Rover press loaner. Police had tracked the vehicle for days via Flock. Root cause: a lost NJ manufacturer plate reported in California was entered into NCIC incomplete as 34 DTM (missing small middle digits); Feder's plate was 34 10 DTM, and Flock OCR also missed those characters. VIN clean; original plate was lost, not stolen; ~1 hour detention.

16. Case_ID: FLK-2026-016 | Year: 2026 | State: CO | Agency_Jurisdiction: Cherry Hills Village Police Dept. | Subject_Officer_Involved: Patrol Officers / Automated System | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Flawed AI Recognition / Wrongful Stop | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: Flock Safety camera data led police to conduct an improper traffic stop on an innocent driver due to character misinterpretation and database synchronization errors.

17. Case_ID: FLK-2026-017 | Year: 2026 | State: AR | Agency_Jurisdiction: Sherwood Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Patrol Officers / Automated System | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Flawed AI Recognition / Gunpoint Detention | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: A Flock camera misread the license plate of an SUV, leading officers to detain an innocent couple at gunpoint while their six-week-old baby sat alone in a car seat in the back of the vehicle.

18. Case_ID: FLK-2025-018 | Year: 2025 | State: WI | Agency_Jurisdiction: Milwaukee Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Officer Josue Ayala | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Officer Ayala conducted 179 unauthorized searches in the Flock Safety system using a single-word justification ('investigation') to stalk a dating partner (>50 searches) and their ex-partner (>100 searches).

19. Case_ID: FLK-2025-019 | Year: 2025 | State: GA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Braselton Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Police Chief Michael Steffman | System_Vendor: Flock Safety / ALPR | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking / Harassment | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Police Chief Steffman abused municipal license plate reader databases to actively track, stalk, and harass multiple people, including a former romantic partner.

20. Case_ID: FLK-2025-020 | Year: 2025 | State: GA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Coffee County Sheriff's Office | Subject_Officer_Involved: Former Deputy Chris Rozar | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Deputy Rozar utilized the department's Flock Safety ALPR database to monitor the movements of a woman he was romantically interested in, tracking her vehicle locations without her consent or any active criminal case.

21. Case_ID: FLK-2025-021 | Year: 2025 | State: GA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Echols County Sheriff's Office | Subject_Officer_Involved: Anna Altobello (Civilian Secretary) | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Personal Tracking / Stalking | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: A civilian secretary at the sheriff's office accessed the agency's Flock Safety account on multiple occasions for non-law enforcement purposes, conducting unauthorized tag searches on two acquaintances.

22. Case_ID: FLK-2025-022 | Year: 2025 | State: CO | Agency_Jurisdiction: Columbine Valley Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Sgt. Jamie Milliman | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Wrongful Accusation / Flawed AI Evidence | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Sgt. Milliman relied blindly on a Flock ALPR camera hit to accuse Denver resident Chrisanna Elser of stealing a \$25 package. Police issued a criminal summons without verifying obvious discrepancies. Elser had to obtain her own vehicle's onboard Rivian video to prove she was miles away when the theft occurred.

23. Case_ID: FLK-2025-023 | Year: 2025 | State: KY | Agency_Jurisdiction: Louisville Metro Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Officer Roberto Cedeno | System_Vendor: Flock Safety / ALPR | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Officer Cedeno utilized the city's automated license plate reader system to track an ex-partner and her friends hundreds of times over a two-month period without any legitimate law enforcement objective.

24. Case_ID: FLK-2025-024 | Year: 2025 | State: WA | Agency_Jurisdiction: King County Sheriff's Office / Covington | Subject_Officer_Involved: Deputy Welch | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Flawed AI Recognition / Excessive Force | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: Deputy Welch received a false Flock Safety alert for a stolen van, drove to a gas station, and tackled an innocent man to the ground, grabbing his waist and forcing him face-down onto pavement in a violent wrongful detention.

25. Case_ID: FLK-2025-025 | Year: 2025 | State: CA | Agency_Jurisdiction: City of El Cajon | Subject_Officer_Involved: City Police Department / Municipal Leadership | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Illegal Data Sharing / Mass Surveillance | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: The City of El Cajon systematically violated California law by sharing Flock ALPR data feeds with out-of-state police agencies and federal border/immigration authorities without required legal guardrails or statutory oversight.

26. Case_ID: FLK-2025-026 | Year: 2025 | State: GA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Buford City Schools Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: School Police Officers | System_Vendor: Flock Safety / ALPR | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Mission Creep / Low-Level Surveillance | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: Between Jan 2025 and March 2026, school police ran more than 375 searches in ALPR tracking databases for low-level 'school residency verification' (RV), representing severe surveillance mission creep without criminal predicate.

27. Case_ID: FLK-2025-027 | Year: 2025 | State: TN | Agency_Jurisdiction: Oak Ridge Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Officer Zachary D. Gauthier | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Unauthorized Access / Personal Tracking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Former Oak Ridge PD Officer Zachary Gauthier accessed the Flock ALPR system 18 times for personal (non-law-enforcement) use between February 25 and March 25, 2025, and also misused Accurant, the State Link System, and his patrol-car computer. An Anderson County Grand Jury indicted him on 23 counts of official misconduct (Class E felony) on July 1, 2025—18 counts specifically for Flock misuse. He was placed on leave April 21, 2025, fired April 24, 2025, and pleaded guilty to all 23 counts on March 23, 2026 (48 hours custody, supervised probation, POST surrender, judicial diversion eligibility). Oak Ridge shares Flock data within the same East Tennessee network as Maryville.

28. Case_ID: FLK-2024-027 | Year: 2024 | State: IL | Agency_Jurisdiction: Matteson Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Officer Jaila Cole-Clark | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Officer Cole-Clark conducted hundreds of unauthorized searches in the department's Flock Safety database to monitor the daily driving routes of her former domestic partner and that person's new partner.

29. Case_ID: FLK-2024-028 | Year: 2024 | State: FL | Agency_Jurisdiction: Orange City Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Officer Jarmarus Brown | System_Vendor: Flock Safety / ALPR | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Officer Brown allegedly used automated license plate readers to stalk his girlfriend and her family members more than 100 times over a seven-month span without any investigative basis.

30. Case_ID: FLK-2024-029 | Year: 2024 | State: CA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Riverside County Sheriff's Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Deputy Alexander Vanny | System_Vendor: Flock Safety / ALPR | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Stalking / Kidnapping Facilitation | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: After being arrested for kidnapping his ex-fiancée, forensic audits revealed Deputy Vanny had used the department's ALPR system to illegally track one of her close friends to monitor their movements and gather intelligence.

31. Case_ID: ALPR-2024-030 | Year: 2024 | State: TN | Agency_Jurisdiction: Shelby County Sheriff's Office | Subject_Officer_Involved: Deputy Thadius Gordon | System_Vendor: ALPR (county database; Flock not confirmed in primary local coverage) | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Domestic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Deputy Gordon accessed county ALPR tracking databases more than 100 times to stalk his ex-wife and monitor her vehicular movements across the jurisdiction without law enforcement purpose.

32. Case_ID: FLK-2024-032 | Year: 2024 | State: SC | Agency_Jurisdiction: York County Sheriff's Office | Subject_Officer_Involved: Patrol Officers / Automated System | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Flawed AI Recognition / Wrongful Stop | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: An automated Flock camera misread alphanumeric characters on a passing license plate, generating an erroneous stolen vehicle alert that resulted in an improper traffic stop of an innocent driver.

33. Case_ID: FLK-2024-033 | Year: 2024 | State: FL | Agency_Jurisdiction: Niceville Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Former Officer Coty Hall | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Co-worker Stalking / Harassment | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Officer Hall utilized the department's Flock camera network to unlawfully track the personal driving routes and movements of a fellow police officer and that officer's spouse.

34. Case_ID: FLK-2023-034 | Year: 2023 | State: CA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Costa Mesa Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Officer Robert Josett | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Officer Josett utilized a Flock camera system to track the movements of his mistress as well as her other romantic interests over an extended period without law enforcement authorization.

35. Case_ID: FLK-2023-035 | Year: 2023 | State: KS | Agency_Jurisdiction: Sedgwick Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Police Chief Lee Nygaard | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Romantic Stalking / Physical Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Police Chief Nygaard used Flock cameras to track his ex-girlfriend's vehicles 228 times over four months and followed her and her new boyfriend in his police cruiser using real-time location alerts.

36. Case_ID: FLK-2022-036 | Year: 2022 | State: KS | Agency_Jurisdiction: Kechi Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Lt. Victor Heiar | System_Vendor: Flock Safety | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Domestic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Lt. Heiar abused municipal Flock license plate tracking databases to monitor the movements of his estranged wife without her consent or any criminal investigation.

37. Case_ID: FLK-2021-037 | Year: 2021 | State: PA | Agency_Jurisdiction: Westmoreland County | Subject_Officer_Involved: Officer Michael McSherry | System_Vendor: ALPR / Automated Systems | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Domestic Stalking | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: Officer McSherry repeatedly accessed automated license plate reader networks to track the vehicular movements of his estranged wife and several other family members.

38. Case_ID: FLK-2020-038 | Year: 2020 | State: KS | Agency_Jurisdiction: Lenexa Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Police Department Leadership / Patrol Officers | System_Vendor: Flock Safety / ALPR | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Retaliation / Political Targeting | Verification_Status: Cited / aggregator-aligned | Detailed_Summary: After citizen Canyen Ashworth published a newspaper op-ed critical of local police cooperation with ICE, police retaliated by linking him to anti-ICE posters put up with glue around town. The Police Chief issued a 'MYOC' (Make Your Own Case) BOLO and utilized ALPR cameras to actively track his vehicle around town to manufacture a reason for a traffic stop.

39. Case_ID: FLK-2020-039 | Year: 2020 | State: CO | Agency_Jurisdiction: Aurora Police Department | Subject_Officer_Involved: Patrol Officers / Automated System | System_Vendor: ALPR (In-car / Automated Reader) | Misuse_Abuse_Category: Flawed AI Recognition / Gunpoint Detention | Verification_Status: Verified | Detailed_Summary: An ALPR system erroneously flagged Brittney Gilliam's minivan as a stolen vehicle (matching the plate number of a stolen motorcycle from Montana). Officers conducted a high-risk gunpoint stop, forcing four children (ages 6 to 17) to lie face-down in handcuffs on hot pavement before verifying the obvious vehicle mismatch.